

Bonecas Russas

for baritone voice, trumpet in B♭, trombone, and bass clarinet in B♭

Felipe Lara
2024

Felipe Lara - Bonecas Russas

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Programme Notes:

Bonecas Russas, “Russian Dolls,” is inspired by a text from Brazilian visual artist and writer Nuno Ramos. This excerpt comes from Ramos’ award-winning, genre-defying book, *Ó* (2009), which offers a multifaceted exploration of language, identity, and the creative process. Through a blend of poetry, prose, and visual elements, Ramos examines the complexities of communication and the human experience. The narrative invites readers to reflect on the relationship between words and their meanings, encouraging contemplation of the limits and possibilities of expression.

My piece explores selections from *Ó*, focusing on themes of self-similarity and nesting, and translates these key concepts into musical characters and textures. In this composition, six distinct musical characters are assigned to specific sections of the text, each with relative temporal durations that influence the overall structure. This creates a layered architecture where each section, phrase, and even the smallest rhythmic motifs are interconnected.

The musical material unfolds like a fractal labyrinth, transforming Ramos’ text into musical objects that vary in scale, from fleeting motifs to expansive passages. The key musical characters include Filtered Drones, Fluidity, Inflate/Deflate, Incisions, Song, and Ricochet.

- Felipe Lara

Text:

Text by Nuno Ramos (with translation by Felipe Lara):

Filtered Drones

Quem põe uma boneca russa dentro da outra é o dia. E quem põe um dia dentro de outro sou eu. Assim, eu e meus dias, como colecionadores, vamos escondendo bonecos iguais a nós mesmos, uns dentro dos outros. Mas não apenas nós, pois a natureza é uma enorme boneca russa também.

"Who puts one Russian doll inside another is the day. And who puts one day inside another is me. Thus, my days and I, like collectors, hide dolls that are just like ourselves, one inside the other. But it's not just us, as nature is also an enormous Russian doll."

Fluidity

E o rio, que não banharia duas vezes o mesmo homem, é uma boneca russa de água, enrolado a si mesmo em turbilhões, repetindo-se enquanto procura o mar.

"And the river, which would not bathe the same man twice, is a Russian doll of water, wrapped around itself in whirlpools, repeating itself while searching for the sea."

Inflate/Deflate

O mar, com suas marés conhecidas, inchando-se e encolhendo-se, ameaçando a todos com os desastres ecológicos mais previsíveis, o mar é uma boneca russa salgada com outros mares sempre iguais e profundos e salgados dentro dela.

"The sea, with its known tides, swelling and shrinking, threatening everyone with the most predictable ecological disasters, the sea is a salty Russian doll with other seas, always the same and deep and salty, inside her."

Incisions

Mesmo a dor da mordida de uma vespa, a inveja mais profunda, o ciúme infernal, a morte do que amamos de fato – repetição, dor dentro da dor, nervo dentro do nervo, coração interno ao coração.

"Even the pain of a wasp sting, the deepest envy, the infernal jealousy, the death of what we truly love – repetition, pain within pain, nerve within nerve, heart internal to the heart"

Song

Com olho dentro dos olhos observo teu corpo de manhã; com dedos dentro dos dedos toquei você ontem a noite. Minha saliva antiga bebeu a tua, não a nova, e em minha raiva foi meu veneno velho, copiado, diluído, que se lançou contra todos.

"With eye within eyes, I observe your body in the morning; with finger within fingers, I touched you last night. My old saliva drank yours, not the new one, and in my wrath was old poison, copied, diluted, which launched itself against all last night."

Ricochet

Não sou a réplica do que fui, nem do que serei, mas do que acontece comigo neste exato momento.

"I am not the replica of what I was, nor of what I will be, but of what is happening to me at this very moment."

Original Model

(Com uma equipe de sócias espalhadas pelas ruas reais e diversas, ofereço prêmios a quem descobrir o modelo original)

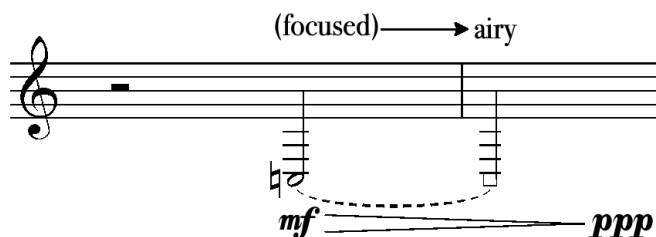
(With a team of look-alikes scattered through real and diverse streets, I offer prizes to those who can identify the original model.)

Performance Notes:

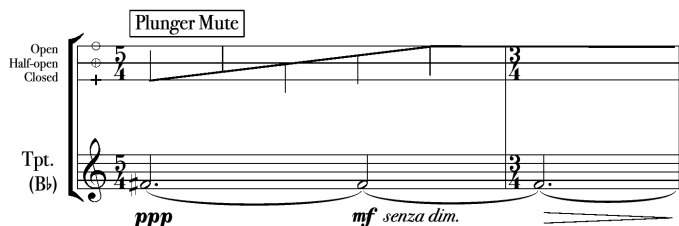
Microtonal notation:

#	1/4 tone sharp	♭	1/4 tone flat
##	3/4 tone sharp	♭♭	3/4 tone flat
↑ ♯ ↑	1/6 tone sharp	↓ ♭ ↓	1/6 tone flat

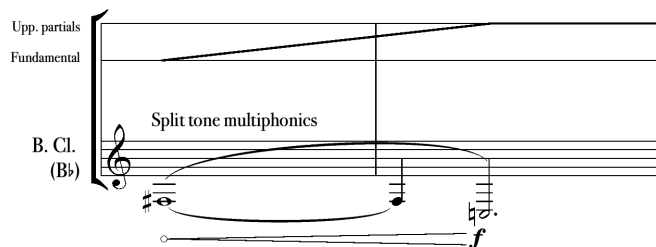
Other notes:



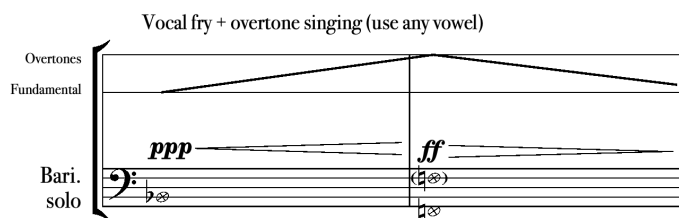
An arrow between two techniques refers to transitioning between them over the duration indicated.



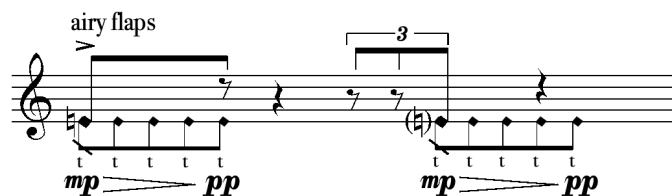
The trumpet and trombone parts feature a "mute staff" that indicates gradual mute transitions.



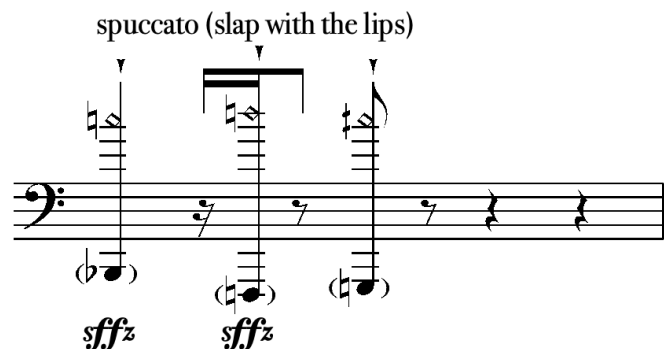
The bass clarinet includes an extra staff to show emphasis on the fundamental or upper partials during split tone multiphonics.



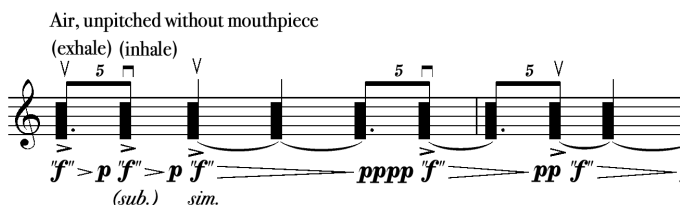
The baritone part features an additional staff to indicate emphasis on either the fundamental or overtones during overtone singing.



This technique involves a light, airy articulation produced by a gentle “t” sound, creating a soft, breathy effect on each note.



Spiccato is a percussive technique where the player "slaps" the lips together to create a strong, accented sound



This effect requires the player to produce an unpitched, airy sound by exhaling and inhaling through the instrument without the mouthpiece.

Durata:

approximately 15 minutes

Transposed Score